

Your books, cleaned up in one sitting.

A do-it-in-order worksheet. Work top to bottom, tick each box, and when you reach the end your file bills by service, your bulky item list is gone, and the “Sales” catch-all is retired. About 40 minutes, plus the optional invoice cleanup at the back.

ITEM LIST TODAY

70+ items

duplicates, one-offs, prices in names



AFTER THIS SHEET

23 items

one clean menu you bill from



INCOME ACCOUNTS

9 service lines

instead of one blurry “Sales”

DO IT IN THIS ORDER — EACH STEP SETS UP THE NEXT

1. **Create** the 11 new accounts (Part 1)
2. **Rename** 4 existing accounts (Part 2)
3. **Rewire** every item's income account (Part 4)
4. **Make inactive** the 49 old items (Part 5)
5. **Retire** “Sales” once it reads \$0 (Part 6)
6. **Fix** 5 small money items (Part 7)

1 Create 11 new accounts

~8 min

Gear ► Chart of accounts ► **New**. For every one of these: **Sub-account?** No · **Description:** leave blank (optional) · **Lock?** No. Only Account type must be exact — detail type is just a label, closest match is fine.

ACCOUNT NAME	ACCOUNT TYPE	DETAIL TYPE
☐ Window Cleaning – Residential	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Window Cleaning – Commercial	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Solar Panel Cleaning	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Screen Repair & Replacement	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Pigeon Proofing / Bird Exclusion	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Exterior Cleaning – Other	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Hard Water Stain Removal	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Materials & Reimbursements	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Other Service Income	Income	Service/Fee Income
☐ Job Materials & Supplies	Cost of Goods Sold	Supplies & Materials – COGS
☐ Owner's Contributions	Equity	Owner's Equity

Owner's Contributions is where every Zelle you send **into** the business lands — that's your “I Zelle myself to fund it” money. It is never income.

2 Rename 4 accounts you already have

~3 min

Renaming keeps every past transaction attached — exactly what you want for sorting the year. Chart of accounts ► dropdown arrow ► Edit. Don't change their type or detail.

CURRENT NAME	NEW NAME	LEAVE TYPE AS
☐ Owner's Pay & Personal Expenses	Owner's Draws	Equity
☐ Ford Maverick - Auto Fuel	Vehicle – Fuel	Expense
☐ QuickBooks Payments Fees	Merchant Processing Fees	Expense
☐ Meals - Business Owner	Meals	Expense

3 Leave these completely alone

read only

Do **not** edit, rename, or hide any of these — some are system accounts, and hiding a bank/loan account with a balance creates a bigger mess:

Discounts given · Customer Deposit (Liability) · your BofA business checking (0802) · Accounts Receivable · Undeposited Funds · Opening Balance Equity · Retained Earnings · *W-2 Job Income (Non-Business) · **every personal bank, loan, and credit-card account** (those come out later, with a CPA).

4 Rewire every item — this empties “Sales”

~12 min

This is the step that lets you retire the Sales category. Sales ► Products & services ► Edit each item ► set its **Income account** ► Save. **Every time it asks “Also update this account in historical transactions?” — check YES.** That pulls your past 2026 revenue out of “Sales” and into the right service line automatically.

ITEM	POINT ITS INCOME ACCOUNT TO →
☐ Window Cleaning - 1 Story Exterior Only	Window Cleaning – Residential
☐ Window Cleaning - 1 Story Interior Add-on	Window Cleaning – Residential
☐ Window Cleaning - 2 Story Exterior Only	Window Cleaning – Residential
☐ Window Cleaning - 2 Story Interior Add-on	Window Cleaning – Residential
☐ Window Cleaning - Commercial	Window Cleaning – Commercial
☐ Solar Panel Cleaning (per panel)	Solar Panel Cleaning
☐ Solar Panel Cleaning	Solar Panel Cleaning
☐ Screen Repair - Standard Mesh (per screen)	Screen Repair & Replacement
☐ Screen Repair - Pet Proof Mesh (per screen)	Screen Repair & Replacement
☐ Screen - New Frame & Screen (per screen)	Screen Repair & Replacement
☐ Pigeon Proofing - Installation & Sealing	Pigeon Proofing / Bird Exclusion
☐ Pigeon Proofing - Cleanout & Debris Removal	Pigeon Proofing / Bird Exclusion
☐ Pigeon proofing spinners	Pigeon Proofing / Bird Exclusion
☐ Pigeon Proofing - Materials & Supplies	Materials & Reimbursements
☐ Materials Reimbursement	Materials & Reimbursements
☐ Gutter Cleaning	Exterior Cleaning – Other
☐ Exterior Cleaning - Other	Exterior Cleaning – Other
☐ Trash Bin Cleaning - First Time	Exterior Cleaning – Other
☐ Trash Bin Cleaning - Maintenance	Exterior Cleaning – Other
☐ Hard Water Stain Removal	Hard Water Stain Removal
☐ Service Call / Trip Fee	Other Service Income
☐ Miscellaneous Labor	Other Service Income
☐ Customer Deposit Received	Customer Deposit (Liability)
☐ “Sales” (the old catch-all item — Staci's screen job)	Screen Repair & Replacement

The one exception: “Customer Deposit Received” points at the **Customer Deposit (Liability)** account — never an income account. A deposit isn't earned until the work is done.

Why this order matters: rewiring first (with “update historical” checked) drains the Sales account. Only after that can you retire it in Part 6. Do the 49 deactivations (Part 5) *after* this, so every item is still easy to find here.

5 Make 49 old items inactive

~5 min

Sales ► Products & services ► tick every item below ► **Batch actions ► Make inactive**. Nothing is deleted — “inactive” just hides them from your menus; all past invoices stay intact and any item can be restored later.

GENERIC / CATCH-ALL

Sales Custom Amount Window Cleaning Exterior Wash Interior Wash

OLD WINDOW & BUNDLE

Exterior Window Cleaning Exterior + Interior Window Cleaning Window Cleaning - 1 Story

Exterior / Interior / + 12 solar panels home bundle \$300

OLD SCREEN

Window Screen Mesh Replacement Screen Mesh Repair (Plus)

Screen Repair - Pet-Proof & Heat-Resistant Mesh (Lifetime Warranty) Discounted Sliding Door Mesh Repair

OLD SOLAR

Solar Panel Cleaning + Bird Mesh Installation Solar Panel Wash + Free Maintenance clean in March

Solar Panel Wash (Complimentary) Solar Array Preparation & Inspection - \$20.00

SPANISH ONE-OFFS

Materiales Limpieza de paneles Seguro Mano de obra Mano de obra Depósito de materiales (20%)

PRICE-IN-THE-NAME LINE ITEMS

8" Galvanized Steel Mesh, Clips & Fasteners - 95.00 Pigeon Nest & Debris Removal - \$35.00

Safety Equipment & Roof Protection - \$15.00 Professional Installation Labor - \$70.00

Cleanup & Final Quality Inspection - \$25.00

OLD PIGEON-PROOFING VARIANTS

Pigeon Proofing Materials - 29 panel system Pigeon Proofing - Wire Mesh Material (per roll) Pigeon Proofing - Clips & Hardware

Pigeon Proofing - Labor & Debris Removal Pigeon Proofing - Disposal & Site Cleanup

Nesting Material Removal & Panel Preparation Professional Labor

BIRD-DETERRENT & ROOF-WASH ONE-OFFS

Bird Deterrent Materials & Hardware Bird Deterrent Installation Labor Roof Wash Materials & Supplies

Roof Wash Labor & Application

CUSTOM-JOB ONE-OFFS

Custom Access Platform Fee Plywood Materials (Reimbursement) Negotiated Discount

Complimentary Roof Tile Crack Sealing Complimentary Roof Wash (Pressure Washing)

STOP SELLING OVERHEAD AS A LINE

Insurance & Job Overhead Safety Equipment & Roof Safety Liability & Insurance Coverage

Lifetime Warranty (Screen Re-Mesh) Lifetime Warranty (Bird Mesh & Clips)

Insurance, warranty & “safety” lines: stop billing these as separate items — customers shouldn't see your overhead itemized. Build it into your labor/install price and mention the warranty in the line description instead.

6 Retire the “Sales” category

~2 min

Two different things are both named “Sales”: the **item** (handled in Parts 4–5) and the income **account** (this step). Retire the account last:

- ☐ Run **Reports ▶ Profit & Loss**, dates Jan 1 – today. Confirm the **Sales** line now reads **\$0.00** (Part 4 moved it into your service lines). If a little revenue lingers, it's from an old one-off item — do the optional invoice cleanup on the last page, or leave it as a small historical bucket.
- ☐ Chart of accounts ▶ find **Sales** ▶ dropdown arrow ▶ **Make inactive**. QuickBooks may label this “Delete,” but it only deactivates — past reports keep their history as “Sales (deleted).”
- ☐ Do the same for **Billable Expense Income** if it's empty. If it won't deactivate, go Gear ▶ Account and settings ▶ Expenses ▶ “Track billable expenses as income” ▶ switch its account to **Materials & Reimbursements**, then make it inactive.

7 Five small money fixes

~10 min

WHAT	AMOUNT	DO THIS
☐ Ron D — unapplied payment (Jul 2025)	\$50.00	Open the payment ▶ apply to their open invoice, or refund
☐ Isaac — unapplied payment (Aug 2025)	\$10.00	Apply to an invoice, or write off
☐ “Sample Customer” — test data	\$5.00	Delete the payment, make the customer inactive
☐ Customer Deposit liability	\$81.00	Confirm it's Mike Miller's deposit; clear it against invoice 1061
☐ Invoice # gaps 1035–46, 1050, 1052, 1055, 1057–58	—	Gear ▶ Audit log ▶ confirm they were deleted drafts, nothing real

Not yours yet: don't touch the personal accounts, *W-2 Job Income, or the –\$66,690 Opening Balance Equity. That separation happens later with a CPA's sign-off.

8 How to bill every job from now on

keep by the desk

- 1 One line per service, standard items only.** The item never changes — quantity, rate, and description do. The description is free text the customer sees; it doesn't affect the books.
- 2 Combos = multiple lines, never a bundle item.** Windows + solar is two lines. Quoted one price? Adjust the line rates so they add up to it.
- 3 Deposits use “Customer Deposit Received,” both ways.** +amount on the deposit invoice, –amount line on the final invoice. Never subtract a deposit in the Discount field.
- 4 Discounts go in the Discount field only** — so you can see what price breaks cost you per year. Never a negative service line.
- 5 Free/courtesy work lives in a description,** never a \$0 line. A scope breakdown before the sale is an **Estimate**, not a \$0 invoice.
- 6 Materials get their own line only on purpose** — the Materials items, at cost. Otherwise price lump-sum and skip it.

CHEAT SHEET — YOU DID... → BILL WITH... → LANDS IN

YOU DID	BILL WITH ITEM	LANDS IN
House windows, outside	Window Cleaning - 1 or 2 Story Exterior Only	Windows – Res.
Inside added on	Window Cleaning - Interior Add-on	Windows – Res.
Storefront / business	Window Cleaning - Commercial	Windows – Comm.
Solar wash	Solar Panel Cleaning (per panel) × count	Solar
Re-mesh screens	Screen Repair - Standard / Pet Proof (per screen)	Screens
Whole new screen	Screen - New Frame & Screen (per screen)	Screens
Pigeon mesh install	Pigeon Proofing - Installation & Sealing	Pigeon Proofing
Nest cleanout / sanitize	Pigeon Proofing - Cleanout & Debris Removal	Pigeon Proofing
Spinners	Pigeon proofing spinners	Pigeon Proofing
Mesh & clips, itemized	Pigeon Proofing - Materials & Supplies	Materials
Gutters · roof wash · bins	Gutter Cleaning · Exterior Cleaning - Other	Exterior – Other
Hard water spots	Hard Water Stain Removal	Hard Water
Odd labor / trip fee	Miscellaneous Labor · Service Call / Trip Fee	Other Service
Deposit taken / applied	Customer Deposit Received (+ then –)	Liability
Price break	<i>Discount field</i>	Discounts

9 The routine that keeps it clean

under 1 hr/wk

EVERY MONDAY · ~30 MIN

Match each customer payment to its invoice — never “Add” a deposit, or income doubles.

Categorize the rest (Zelle to you = Draw; personal = Draw; between your accounts = Transfer).

Invoice last week's jobs; nudge anything 3+ days overdue.

Check: no account negative, Undeposited Funds empty, no negative A/R.

LAST DAY OF MONTH · ~30 MIN

Reconcile each business account to its statement.

Read the P&L, this month vs last.

Sales by Product/Service — your service scoreboard.

A/R Aging — call anyone 14+ days out.

Set aside 25–30% of net profit for taxes.

During the week: photograph every receipt into the QuickBooks mobile app at the register — ten seconds, and it saves you a deduction hunt later.

10 Payments — verified & the one thing left

status

✓ **Invoice side is verified.** All 14 invoices of 2026 — **\$5,568.80** — show paid in full. No missing customer payments.

 **Bank side needs one file from you.** Log in to Bank of America ► business checking (...0802) ► **Download ► CSV**, dates **Jan 1, 2026 → today** ► send it over. I'll tie every payment to its actual deposit (right amount, right account, once, fees accounted), flag anything unmatched or duplicated, and categorize your whole expense backlog for your approval — that's where your missing tax deductions are.

Already done for you: the 9 standard items created in QuickBooks · your written manuals, payment log, and this worksheet saved on the project's bookkeeping branch · the foldable on-screen version of this guide.

★ Optional: rewrite the 14 invoices for a spotless year

~35 min

Part 4 moves your *keeper items*' revenue out of "Sales." But revenue billed on old one-off items stays in Sales for the year unless you also touch those invoices. Since there are only **14**, editing them is the honest way to get a 100%-clean, bill-by-service year and a truly empty Sales account. **Keep each invoice's total identical** (adjust rates to match) so the applied payment stays put.

INVOICE	TOTAL	REPLACE OLD LINES WITH
☐ 1032 · Linda	\$249	Window Cleaning - 2 Story Exterior Only \$249 → Windows-Res
☐ 1034 · Miguel	\$140	Customer Deposit Received \$140 → Liability (was booked as income — this corrects it)
☐ 1033 · Miguel	\$1,560	Materials & Supplies \$700 · Solar Panel Cleaning \$400 · Installation & Sealing \$600 · <i>then</i> Customer Deposit Received -\$140 (replaces the fake \$140 discount)
☐ 1047 · Carie	\$220	Window Cleaning ext + Interior Add-on, rates summing \$220 → Windows-Res
☐ 1048 · Irene	\$0	Review: a \$0 invoice. If it was a quote, delete & make an Estimate; if the job happened, build a real invoice
☐ 1049 · Antonio	\$120	Solar Panel Cleaning \$120 → Solar
☐ 1054 · Wayne	\$55	Window Cleaning - 1 Story Exterior Only, rate \$55 → Windows-Res
☐ 1051 · Staci	\$570.89	Screen Repair - Pet Proof ×10 @ \$52.99 + slider \$40.99 → Screens
☐ 1053 · Heather	\$320	1 Story Exterior \$149 + Interior Add-on \$75 + Solar (per panel) ×12 @ \$8 → Windows-Res + Solar
☐ 1056 · Bridget	\$675	Materials & Supplies \$320 · Cleanout \$105 · Installation & Sealing \$250 → Pigeon + Materials
☐ 1059 · Linda Smith	\$239	1 Story Exterior \$149 + Solar Panel Cleaning \$90 → Windows-Res + Solar
☐ 1060 · Sarah	\$280	Window Cleaning \$200 + Solar Panel Cleaning \$80 → Windows-Res + Solar
☐ 1061 · Mike Miller	\$879	Materials \$320.99 · Cleanout \$145 · Installation & Sealing \$344.01 · spinners \$150 · Deposit -\$81 (replaces the \$81 discount)
☐ 1062 · Linda Smith	\$260.91	Screen Repair - Standard ×9 @ \$33.99, then \$45 in the Discount field → Screens

Not up for this now? That's fine — skip it. Part 4 already fixes everything going forward; the only cost of skipping is that early-2026 history keeps a small "Sales (deleted)" bucket. You can also send me the BofA CSV and I'll hand you the exact edits alongside the expense cleanup.

Prepared from your live QuickBooks file, Jul 17 2026. Bookkeeping guidance, not tax advice — confirm the California materials/sales-tax point and your vehicle-deduction method with a CPA. Full manuals live in the project's **bookkeeping/** folder on the `claude/window-cleaning-quickbooks-wnh2y7` branch.